Republic of the Philippines
**PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY**
**Camarines Sur**

October 24, 2022

**DR. RAUL G. BRADECINA, PhD**
SUC President III
Partido State University

Dear Sir,

The Partido State University (PSU) is among the Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in the country involved in the **"Phytochemical Characterization of Macro algae for Food and High value Products" (PhycoPRO)** project as a collaborator under the supervision of Dr. Michael A. Clores. The collaborative research project is financed by the Leading Advancement of Knowledge in Agriculture and Sciences (LAKAS) Program of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED).

By providing crucial information through a phytochemical characterization of seaweeds, the project aims to improve the position of the seaweed business in the Philippines by identifying species with higher economic potential and areas where their growth will be most robust.

Among **the initial activity of the project and a collaborative responsibility of the Partido State University is to communicate and identify potential seaweed biodiversity sampling sites in the region.** The information obtained from the initial site visits will be communicated to the UP Marine Science Institute as the implementing HEIs of the PhycoPRO project, which can be utilized for the next biodiversity sampling of the collaborating HEIs in the early part of 2023.

We respectfully send our proposed research activity proposal for initial seaweed biodiversity sampling in Virac and San Andres, Catanduanes, on November 13 – 16, 2022, for your approval to finalize the preparations for the above activities. The proposal highlights the activity's rationale, objectives, expected outputs, and the needed budget requirements with item particulars also specified. We would like to note that **the ACTIVITY proposed is *NOT* a new research proposal as it is among the activities attached to the externally funded CHED-LAKAS program in that our humble institution is a collaborating HEI.**

We are hoping for your immediate and favorable response on this matter. Thank you very much.

Sincerely,

**MICHAEL A. CLORES, PhD**
Coordinator, PhycoPRO CHED LAKAS Project, and
Campus Dean, ParSU-Caramoan Campus

PARTIDO STATE UNIVERSITY
OFFICE OF THE PRESIDENT
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BY: 6 DATE: OCT 25 2022
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Endorsed:

**MS. LUISA M. LANCISO**
*Director, Research and Development*

**PROF. PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA**
*Vice President, Research, Extension, and Knowledge Management*

Approved:

**RAUL G. BRADECINA, Ph.D.**
SUC President III
Partido State University

# RESEARCH ACTIVITY PROPOSAL

Title: **Initial Seaweed Biodiversity Sampling for the Phytochemical Characterization of Macro algae for Food and High-Value Products (PhycoPRO) in the Catanduanes Island Province**

Proponent and Implementing Department: Michael A. Clores, Ph.D. | Caramoan Campus

Planned Date of Implementation: **November 13 – 16, 2022**

Planned Venue: Virac and San Andres, Catanduanes

Participants:

1. Dr. Michael A. Clores (Research Collaborator/ Project Staff)
2. Eljenmer Sindo (URA)
3. Elluna Bigcas (URA)
4. Six (6) Volunteer Faculty/ Personnel

Rationale: The Partido State University (PSU) is among the Higher Education Institutions (HEIs) in the country involved in the PhycoPRO project as a collaborator under the supervision of Dr. Michael A. Clores. The project is funded by the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) through its Leading Advancement of Knowledge in Agriculture and Sciences (LAKAS) Program. The project is envisioned to enhance the status of the seaweed industry in the Philippines by providing critical knowledge through a comprehensive phytochemical characterization of seaweeds to identify species with higher economic potential and pinpoint locations where their growth will be maximal. Specifically,

1. The proposed research activity will allow for identifying key sites in Virac and San Andres, Catanduanes for seaweed sampling and collection.
2. These seaweed samples will be subjected to various phytochemical tests for possible high-value compounds of great utility in product development.
3. It will also allow for the identification of seaweed species that are more profitable for a specific location, guide seaweed farmers on what species they will prioritize for farming and improving mariculture methods.
4. The sampling and the conduct thereof will also facilitate knowledge and skill transfer from experts to the parties involved in the research activity.

Objectives:

1. Identify potential seaweed biodiversity sampling sites in the Virac and San Andres, Catanduanes, which will be communicated to the UP MSI, as the implementing HEI of the PhycoPRO project.
2. Determine and identify seaweed samples of maximal growth in the site.
3. Strengthen research collaboration and linkages of the Partido State University with other institutions in the country.
4. Establish involvement between the involved research institutions and local communities for socio-economic purposes.
5. Obtain, collect, and preserve seaweed samples at the mentioned above site.
6. Facilitate knowledge and skill transfer between the experts, research assistants, faculty, and interested parties on site selection, seaweed collection, identification, and preservation.

Expected Output:

1. Identification of sites in Virac and San Andres, Catanduanes for seaweed collection.
2. Collection of seaweed samples from the selected sites.
3. Conduct initial seaweed biodiversity sampling.
4. Facilitation of knowledge and skills transfer from the experts to the other parties involved in the research activity.

Funding Requirement/Estimated Budget: **PHP 80,280.00**

| Item | Quantity | Unit Cost (PHP) | Total Cost (PHP) |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Food (4 Days)* | | | |
| Breakfast | 9 x 4 = 36 | 200 | 7,200.00 |
| Morning snack | 9 x 4 = 36 | 100 | 3,600.00 |
| Lunch | 9 x 4 = 36 | 200 | 7,200.00 |
| Afternoon snack | 9 x 4 = 36 | 100 | 3,600.00 |
| Dinner | 9 x 4 = 36 | 200 | 7,200.00 |
| Midnight/Night Snack | 9 x 3 = 27 | 100 | 2,700.00 |
| *Accommodation (4 Days, 3 Nights)* | | | |
| Hotel; 3 rooms for 9 participants | 3 x 3= 9 | 2,500 | 22,500.00 |
| *Travel* | | | |
| Caramoan to Naga | 9 | 400 | 3,600.00 |
| Naga to Catanduanes | 9 | 600 | 5,400.00 |
| Virac to San Andres | 9 | 300 | 2,700.00 |
| San Andres to Virac | 9 | 300 | 2,700.00 |
| Catanduanes to Naga | 9 | 600 | 5,400.00 |
| Naga to Caramoan | 9 | 400 | 3,600.00 |
| *Communication* | | | |
| Prepaid Load | 9 | 320 | 2,880.00 |
| | | **Total Cost:** | **80,280.00** |

**Source of Fund: Indirect Cost of the PhycoPRO Project**

Prepared by:

**MICHAEL A. CLORES, PhD**
ParSU Caramoan Campus Dean
PhycoPRO Research Collaborator/ Project Staff
Date: October 21, 2022

Certified as to Availability of Funds/Applicability of Object of Expenditures: TF (PhycoPRO)

**AMALIA O. OCAMPO**
Administrative Officer V
Budgeting Section Chief
Date:

**NANCY C. ENCINAS**
Accountant III
Accounting Section Chief
Date: 10/24/22

Reviewed by:

**PERLITA D. MAÑAGO**
Chief Administrative Officer
Date: 10/24/22

Recommending Approval:

**LUISA M. LANCISO**
Director, Research and Development
Date:

**PATRICIA M. CANDELARIA**
VP for Research, Extension, and Knowledge Management
Date:

Approved:

**RAUL G. BRADECINA, Ph.D.**
SUC President III
Date: